

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Quake adds to Myanmar war crisis

Death toll surpasses 2,000; armed groups hamper aid delivery

By David Rising
Associated Press

BANGKOK — The death toll in last week's massive earthquake in Myanmar has passed 2,000, state media said Monday, as accounts of some people's last moments emerged: Two hundred Buddhist monks crushed by a collapsing monastery. Fifty children killed

when a preschool classroom crumbled. Seven hundred Muslims struck while praying at mosques for Ramadan.

The quake could exacerbate hunger and disease outbreaks in a country that was already one of the world's most challenging places for humanitarian organizations to operate because of civil war, aid groups and the United Nations

warned.

The 7.7-magnitude quake hit Friday, with the epicenter near Myanmar's second-largest city, Mandalay. It damaged the city's airport, buckled roads and collapsed hundreds of buildings along a wide swath down the country's center.

Relief efforts are further hampered by power outages, fuel

shortages and spotty communications. A lack of heavy machinery has slowed search-and-rescue operations, forcing many to search for survivors by hand in daily temperatures above 104 degrees Fahrenheit.

Rescue workers at Mandalay's collapsed U Hla Thein monastery said they were still searching for about 150 of the dead monks.

Seven hundred Muslim worshippers attending Friday prayers were killed when

mosques collapsed, said Tun Kyi, a member of the steering committee of the Spring Revolution Myanmar Muslim Network. About 60 mosques were damaged or destroyed. Videos posted on The Irrawaddy online news site showed several mosques toppling.

It was not clear whether those numbers were already included in the official toll.

Myanmar state MRTV reported

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New tariffs could put squeeze on developers

More expensive steel and aluminum may lead to higher rents

By Brian J. Rogal
Chicago Tribune

New tariffs on steel and aluminum could force Chicago apartment developers, already affected by elevated interest rates and soaring labor costs, to further delay breaking ground on new projects.

The White House began implementing tariffs of 25% on global steel and aluminum imports March 12, saying it wants to stimulate domestic production. But experts say tariffs will also make the crucial materials more expensive, forcing developers to pass higher costs onto tenants, or make it tougher to secure financing and kick off construction. Down the road, that could mean higher rents and fewer choices for those looking for housing.

"It's a very difficult environment for the construction industry," said Julie Workman, a Chicago-based real estate attorney and partner at Saul Ewing LLP. "Uncertainty and delay can kill deals. Time kills deals."

The Trump administration further increased uncertainty by announcing a different series of on-again, off-again tariffs on top trading partners such as Canada and Mexico, only to pull back several days later. That makes the overall impact from tariffs difficult to gauge, said Omar Rihani, executive

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'Flagship' DMV opens in the Loop

The Illinois secretary of state's office opened a downtown Chicago location for driver and vehicle services. The new facility at 125 W. Monroe St. is nearly five times the size of downtown's former office at the corner of Randolph and LaSalle streets, which closed on Friday. **Page 2**

Street race plan announced

NASCAR and the city announced the traffic plan for the third Chicago Street Race, shaving nearly two weeks off last year's construction schedule for the July Fourth weekend event. **Business**

France's far-right leader convicted

A French court convicted Marine Le Pen of embezzlement and barred her from seeking public office for five years. **Nation & World**



E. JASON WAMBSGANS/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

3rd child dies of injuries from Carpentersville fire

Neighbors visit a memorial Monday outside the home where two children were killed in a Sunday morning fire in the 1700 block of Kingston Circle in Carpentersville. A third boy died Sunday night at Loyola University Medical Center in Maywood. According to Village President John Skillman it was the first fatal fire involving children in the village in more than 20 years. **Chicagoland, Page 3**



Chicago Teachers Union President Stacy Davis Gates speaks as Chicago Firefighters Union Local 2 President Pat Cleary, right, listens while dozens of Chicago Teachers Union and firefighters union members and supporters rally March 24. **ANTONIO PEREZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

CPS and teachers union reach proposed contract agreement

Tentative deal brings an end to a year of tough negotiations

By Nell Salzman, Alice Yin and Gregory Royal Pratt
Chicago Tribune

Chicago Teachers Union educators voted on a final proposed contract deal with the school district Monday, capping

months of contentious negotiations and leadership conflicts that threatened to destabilize the nation's fourth-largest district.

The road to a tentative agreement — which could still fall through — has seen almost a year of false starts and mounting pressures over how the district will afford both the teachers contract and a \$175 million pension payment for nonteaching staff that's at the center of a game of

political football between City Hall and Chicago Public Schools.

Per protocol, a bargaining team of over a dozen teachers will look at the proposal package and decide if they recommend it. The proposals then move to the union's executive board to be finalized as a tentative agreement, approved by the CTU House of Delegates on

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'Michael Madigan is not corrupt'

Attorneys for ex-speaker want convictions tossed over alleged missteps

By Jason Meisner and Ray Long
Chicago Tribune

Lawyers for convicted former House Speaker Michael Madigan are arguing for a new trial in his corruption case, saying prosecutors failed to prove the then-powerful Democrat knew about a scheme by ComEd to pay off his associates and alleging a series of mistakes by the trial judge.

The 73-page motion filed Friday alleged those errors tainted the jury with highly prejudicial evidence, and asked U.S. District Judge John Robert Blakey to reverse the jury's verdict on certain guilty counts and grant a new trial on others.

Such post-trial motions are routine and rarely granted, however the filing provides a blueprint for a likely appeal to the 7th U.S. Circuit Court of

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